



rule sounds, success is often gotten by following the set procedure for doing things. Yes, there is always scope for creativity, and gamers seem to abound with that, but we all know that we will follow instructions diligently if we know that success depends on it.



3 HAND-EYE COORDINATION

When playing fast-paced games – shooters such as *Counter Strike*, *Battlefield*, *Quake* or *Call of Duty*, or a racing game such as *Forza* or *Need for Speed* – a gamer needs to keep track of a lot of things. You need to aim and position yourself in shooters, and in racers, you need to fine tune your steering skills and in all action games, you need to have good reflexes. Of course, we're not suggesting that gamers would make excellent sportsmen – because frankly that would be ridiculous. However, since gamers are already usually geeky and the indoors types (exceptions like you notwithstanding), it doesn't hurt for them to hone their hand-eye coordina-



tion. Studies have shown that surgeons can hone their hand skills by gaming... So now you can tell your parents you're practicing to become a doctor when you're fragging people in *CS: GO*.

With gaming now going mainstream, more and more people are taking it up, and games are becoming more challenging as well. Plus, even simple games such as *Temple Run* on phones or tablets have a lot of us honing our reflexes on a daily basis.

With VR coming soon, we expect that multitasking and hand-eye-coordination are going to become even more important in games, and thus we will improve our skills not just by sitting on our backsides, but also while up on our feet and moving about. That should also help us shed a few pounds that we've put on from all the Red Bull and junk food we consume during our gaming binges.

4 STRATEGY, PLANNING AND MULTITASKING

Real time strategy (RTS) games often require us to manage a ton of resources, troops and units. Games such as *Age of Empires*, *Warcraft*, and *Starcraft* are prime examples of this genre. Although



you may think that RTS games only need for a player to become super fast at carrying out tasks and basically just have faster typing and mouse skills, nothing could be further from the truth.

Some of us here at Digit have beaten people at RTS games who were all about speed, simply by being better at planning and strategy. Put quite simply, a better brain will always beat a faster hand in an RTS. What this genre really teaches you is to think of multiple things at once, and not just type / execute commands at the speed of light, but also quickly read a situation, think ahead, and plan for pretty much all outcomes. This is a very handy skill to develop when you have high-stress jobs, or jobs that require a lot of multi-

tasking – doctors, surgeons, paramedics, lawyers, field engineers, stock analyst, etc. Actually, pretty much all jobs today have an aspect of this requirement, and with technology becoming all pervasive, the ability to work quickly, efficiently and strategically with tech is a huge boon.

5 LEARNING TECHNICAL SKILLS

There's many games that actually teach you a new skill. You actually learn to play guitar with games such as *Rocksmith 2014*, and of course you can play games such as *Rock Band* to get the idea of how to follow a song's rhythm, and also get interested in playing an instrument.

You can improve your geography skills with games such as *80 Days*, as you circumnavigate the world. You can use the realistic physics of space program sims such as the *Kerbal Space Program*, to learn a thing or two about physics. Even *Minecraft* helps you brush up on your electrical engineering skills – you can automate a home using redstone found within the game to power devices and control them via levers and switches. There are games that help you improve your programming and typing skills, such as *SpaceChem* or *Code Combat* (programming) and *TypeRacer* or *TapTyping* respectively. If you've got two left feet, you can improve your dancemoves with games such as *Just Dance* or *Dance Dance Revolution*. Actually, if there's an activity that is popular enough for more than a few humans to do, there's probably a game dedicated to it. There's no better or more fun way to learn something than via a game.

6 GET CULTURED

Games such as *Assassin's Creed* and *Age of Empires* (to name a few) are set in the distant past. They are often set in historical times, and even refer to events that are historically accurate. By playing the game, without even realising it, you have picked up on some ancient

